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Updated October 2026

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EDUCATION

University of California, Davis
Ph.D. in Economics — *2021–June 2027 (expected)*
Fields: International Economics, Macroeconomics, Geoeconomics

Korea University
Ph.D. Program in Economics *(prior to UC Davis)* — *2019–2021*
M.A. in Economics, *Best Thesis Award* — *2017–2019*
B.A. in Economics, *Magna Cum Laude* — *2012–2017*

REFERENCES

Paul Bergin (Chair)
Professor
Department of Economics
University of California, Davis
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Katheryn Russ
Professor
Department of Economics
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Ina Simonovska
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
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Emile A. Marin
Assistant Professor
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JOB MARKET PAPER

Financial Sanctions and Dollar Dominance in Trade Invoicing [draft]

Abstract. This paper documents signs that the long-standing dominance of the U.S. dollar in global trade invoicing is beginning to falter, a development associated with U.S. financial sanctions. Theoretically, I propose a novel mechanism linking invoicing currency choice to sanctions: invoicing in dollars exposes firms to uncertainty about cash flows under sanctions, which can lead creditors to limit working-capital lending. Firms balance this financing risk against the benefits of dollar invoicing in terms of liquidity and reduced exchange-rate risk. Using country-level import invoicing data, I find a small but measurable shift away from dollar invoicing. Stronger U.S. sanctions against Chinese entities are associated with larger declines in dollar invoicing shares and larger increases in renminbi invoicing shares in countries with greater pre-existing import exposure to China. For a 10-percentage-point higher initial share of imports from China, a one-standard-deviation increase in sanctions is associated with a 0.8-percentage-point larger decline in the dollar invoicing share and a 0.2-percentage-point larger rise in the renminbi invoicing share on impact. Consistent with the mechanism, suggestive evidence indicates that the renminbi response is weaker where imports from China are concentrated in industries with lower working-capital needs. These findings suggest that sanctions can weaken dollar dominance by making dollar invoicing a source of financing risk.

Presentations: Southern Economic Association (2026, scheduled); Western Economic Association International Annual Conference (2026); UC Davis Macro/International Seminar (2025, 2026).

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: Republic of Korea; U.S. Permanent Resident (Green Card holder)
Language: Korean (native), English (fluent)
Programming skills: Stata, Python, R, Matlab, LaTeX

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

- *"Purchasing Power Parity vs. Uncovered Interest Rate Parity for NAFTA Countries: The value of Incorporating Time-Varying Parameter Model."*. Economic Modelling, 90 (2020), (with Jong Cheol Yoon and Sang Young Jei)
- *"Empirical Test of Purchasing Power Parity Using a Time-Varying Cointegration Model for China and the UK."*. Physica A: Statistical Mechanics and its Applications, 521 (2019), (with Jong Cheol Yoon and Sang Young Jei)
- *"Impact of Price Disclosure on Gas Market Pricing: Applying Time-varying Cointegration Models."*. Journal of Industrial Economics and Business, 32(5) (2019), (with Jong Cheol Yoon and Sang Young Jei)
- *"Impacts of China's Trade on Sectoral Employment Rates."*. Journal of Industrial Economics and Business, 32(3) (2019), (with Jong Chan Lee and Sang Young Jei)
- *"Analysis of the Estimation of Demand Elasticity for Non-Alcoholic Beverage."*. Journal of The Korean Data Analysis Society, 21(1) (2019), (with Won Nyon Kim and Sang Young Jei)
- *"China's International Trade and Employment by Sector: Private versus Public."*. Journal of The Korean Data Analysis Society, 20(3) (2018), (with Jong Chan Lee and Sang Young Jei)

WORKING PAPERS

- "Promotional Slack and the Strategic Pass-Through of Local Sugar-Sweetened Beverage Taxes" (with Yijoong Won and Kristin Kiesel)
- "Does Habitual Demand Survive a Household Health Shock? Evidence from Retail Diabetes-Device Purchases" (with Yifan Xie)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Tariff News and Inflation Expectations" (with Hyunseo Park and Yungu Cho)
- "The Impact of Economic and Monetary Union on Adjustment Speed" (with Sang Young Jei)
- "Diplomatic Partnerships and the Political Sensitivity of Chinese Outbound Investment" (with Nina Yang)

GRANTS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND AWARDS

- Department Travel Awards, UC Davis — 2025 SQ, 2026 SQ
- Innovation Support Project Scholarship, Korea University — Spring 2019–Fall 2019
- Best Thesis Awards, Korea University — Fall 2019
- Brain Korea 21 Scholarship, Korea University — Fall 2018
- KIMKEEWHA's Research Scholarships, Korea University — Spring 2018, Spring 2019–Spring 2020
- Research Assistant Scholarships, Korea University — Fall 2017–Fall 2020
- Teaching Fellow Scholarships, Korea University — Fall 2017–Fall 2018, Fall 2019
- Dean's List, Korea University — Spring 2016, Spring 2017

POLICY PAPERS

- *"Analysis of the Effects of Infrastructure Investment on Economic Growth"*. National Assembly Budget Office, (2020), (with Yonghun Jung and Lee, Seong-Hoon) (Korean)
- *"The Economic Effects of Gyeongbu-Expressway"*. Korea Expressway Corporation Research Institute, (2020), (with Yonghun Jung and Lee, Seong-Hoon) (Korean)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Tutor, UC Davis *Sep 2026–present*

- **Course:** Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory.
- Hold three hours of drop-in tutoring per week, respond to student questions by email, and offer individual appointments as needed; review lectures or recordings to stay current with course material.

Teaching Assistant, UC Davis *Sep 2021–July 2026*

- **Courses:** Principles of Microeconomics; Principles of Macroeconomics; Intermediate Microeconomic Theory; Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory; Economics of International Immigration; Public Finance; Financial Economics; Money, Banks, and Financial Institutions.
- Led discussions and exam reviews; prepared materials, held office hours, and graded exams.
- Evaluation records: 35 discussion sections; 1,282 cumulative enrollments across 17 terms.
- Overall TA teaching effectiveness: **4.3/5** (380 ratings; reported department average: 3.9/5).

Teaching Assistant, Korea University *Sep 2017–Aug 2021*

- **Courses:** Mathematics for Economics & Business; Statistics for Economists; Theory and Practice of Public Finance; Econometrics; Taxation and National Economy; Introduction to Financial Time Series Data Analysis; Introduction to Economic Fluctuations.
- Held office hours, graded exams, and participated in lectures; led coding sessions for Introduction to Financial Time Series Data Analysis.

WORKING PAPER ABSTRACTS

Promotional Slack and the Strategic Pass-Through of Local Sugar-Sweetened Beverage Taxes (with Yijoong Won and Kristin Kiesel)

Abstract. The effective price a consumer pays at a store combines a regular price with temporary promotions. A tax can raise the regular price, cut the frequency of discounts, or both. This paper asks how retailers strategically respond to sugar-sweetened beverage (SSB) taxes implemented locally and distinguished between these two. We develop a simple conceptual model that makes the regular price costly, while changes to promotions are relatively cheaper, but bounded by pre-tax promotional patterns. We then study retailer pricing behavior after the introduction of the 2018 San Francisco sugar-sweetened beverage tax using NielsenIQ scanner data. Utilizing a local projection difference-in-differences approach, we detect an average pass-through of 73 percent. However, low-promotional slack groups, grocery stores and soft drinks, move the regular price and high-promotional slack group, discount stores, cut promotions and hold the regular price nearly flat. Because incidence can run through promotions that the effective price miss, the distributional reading of these taxes depends on which margin moves.

Presentations: UC Davis Theory/Behavior Seminar (2025).

Does Habitual Demand Survive a Household Health Shock? Evidence from Retail Diabetes-Device Purchases (with Yifan Xie)

Abstract. Soft-drink purchases are highly persistent, and macroeconomic models use habit formation in individual goods to explain sluggish demand and incomplete price pass-through. Evidence for this mechanism largely comes from responses to price, tax, and income shocks, which may also reflect slow price adjustment or delayed awareness. We examine whether this persistence extends to a household-specific health event. Using Nielsen scanner data linked to survey-reported diagnoses, we identify retail monitoring onset from households' first observed purchases of glucose meters or test strips. Local projection difference-in-differences estimates compare these households with those recording neither a monitoring purchase nor a diabetes diagnosis. Regular soda purchases decline within two quarters and remain lower for two years. The average reduction is 70.5 ounces per household per quarter, approximately 11 percent of purchases before onset. The decline in regular soda's share is accompanied by a corresponding increase in diet soda's share. Among households whose monitoring purchases precede the reported diagnosis year, the decline begins in the purchase quarter. The adjustment is concentrated in the first two quarters, while roughly 90 percent of baseline purchases remain. These findings suggest that households respond promptly to the onset of retail monitoring but make limited changes to an otherwise persistent purchasing pattern.